

EMPOWERX EXPERT COMMITTEE CHARTER AND REMUNERATION POLICY

Version 2.0

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1. Purpose

The EmpowerX Expert Committee is an independent technical body established to support the EmpowerX incubation ecosystem by providing professional, transparent and impartial assessments of projects submitted for incubation.

The Committee contributes to the quality of the selection process by ensuring that each proposal is evaluated according to objective, verifiable and merit-based criteria before being submitted to the governance process.

The Committee does not replace the EmpowerX DAO or the operational role of the Holding. Instead, it provides independent technical assessments that support informed decision-making within the hybrid governance model adopted by the EmpowerX ecosystem.

2. Guiding Principles

The activities of the Expert Committee are based on the following principles:

- independence;
- competence;
- transparency;
- accountability;
- meritocracy;
- absence of conflicts of interest;
- equal treatment of all applicants.

Every evaluation must be based exclusively on the merits of the project and never on personal, financial or political considerations.

3. Role of the Expert Committee

The Committee is responsible for:

- reviewing applications submitted to the EmpowerX incubation program;
- evaluating technical feasibility, business sustainability, legal compliance and ecosystem impact;
- issuing reasoned evaluation reports;
- identifying strengths, weaknesses and potential risks;
- recommending improvements where appropriate;
- supporting the quality of the overall incubation process.

The Committee does not allocate funds directly and does not make final governance decisions.

4. Position within the EmpowerX Governance Model

The EmpowerX governance model consists of three complementary levels:

First Level – Technical Screening

Initial verification of documentation, eligibility requirements and completeness of the application.

Second Level – Expert Committee

Independent technical evaluation performed by qualified experts according to standardized criteria.

Third Level – Governance

Projects that successfully complete the evaluation process may proceed to the governance stage in accordance with the EmpowerX governance framework.

This structure combines professional due diligence with community participation while preserving both technical quality and decentralised governance.

5. Composition

The Expert Committee shall consist of professionals with demonstrated experience in one or more of the following fields:

- entrepreneurship;
- finance;
- blockchain technologies;
- software development;
- cybersecurity;
- marketing;
- legal and regulatory compliance;
- intellectual property;
- sustainability and impact assessment;
- other areas relevant to the EmpowerX ecosystem.

Members may be internal or external to the EmpowerX ecosystem.

Appointments are based exclusively on competence, experience and professional reputation.

6. Appointment and Term

Members are appointed according to the governance procedures adopted by EmpowerX.

Appointments are made for a limited term and may be renewed.

Periodic renewal of the Committee promotes diversity of perspectives, prevents concentration of influence and preserves the independence of the evaluation process.

7. Independence and Conflict of Interest

Independence is a fundamental requirement.

Before evaluating any project, each member shall disclose any circumstance that may create an actual, potential or perceived conflict of interest.

Examples include:

- ownership interests;
- advisory relationships;
- employment;
- family relationships;
- significant financial interests;
- any circumstance that could reasonably compromise impartiality.

Members with conflicts of interest shall abstain from the evaluation of the relevant project and shall not participate in related discussions or decisions.

8. Confidentiality

Committee members shall treat all information received during the evaluation process as confidential.

Confidential information may only be used for evaluation purposes and shall not be disclosed except where required by law or expressly authorised by EmpowerX.

Members may also be required to execute a Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA).

9. Code of Conduct

Members undertake to:

- act honestly and professionally;
- maintain impartiality;
- avoid preferential treatment;
- respect applicants;
- preserve the reputation of the EmpowerX ecosystem;
- perform evaluations diligently and within agreed timelines.

Failure to comply with these principles may result in suspension or removal from the Committee.

10. Remuneration Principles

Expert Committee members may receive compensation for evaluation activities.

Compensation is intended to recognise professional work performed and shall never depend upon whether a project is approved or rejected.

The remuneration framework is designed to preserve independence and eliminate incentives that could influence evaluation outcomes.

11. Source of Compensation

Compensation is funded exclusively through resources allocated by the EmpowerX Ecosystem Treasury, subject to the governance framework and the financial sustainability of the ecosystem.

No dedicated token allocation is reserved exclusively for the Expert Committee.

The Treasury may finance evaluation activities alongside other ecosystem functions, including:

- incubation programs;
- educational initiatives;
- ecosystem grants;
- governance activities;
- technology development;
- community initiatives;
- operational sustainability.

12. Compensation Model

Compensation may consist of one or more of the following:

- EMX tokens;
- stablecoins;
- hybrid remuneration combining digital assets and fiat-equivalent payments.

The applicable model may evolve over time according to governance decisions and ecosystem maturity.

The amount of compensation may vary depending on:

- complexity of the evaluation;
- expected workload;
- available Treasury resources;
- sustainability objectives of the ecosystem.

13. Cooling-Off Period

- To preserve complete independence, Expert Committee members shall not receive, directly or indirectly:
- equity;
- tokens;
- advisory agreements;
- consulting contracts;
- success fees;
- any other financial benefit

from an applicant project for a defined cooling-off period established by the EmpowerX governance framework following completion of the evaluation.

14. Reputation and Quality Assurance

EmpowerX may implement reputation mechanisms to encourage high-quality evaluations.

Such mechanisms may include:

- peer review;
- periodic performance assessment;
- feedback from governance bodies;
- reputation scores;
- continuing education requirements.

These mechanisms are intended to improve the quality and consistency of evaluations rather than to influence individual decisions.

15. Amendments

This Charter may be amended through the governance procedures adopted by EmpowerX.

Any amendments shall preserve the fundamental principles of:

- independence;
- transparency;
- meritocracy;
- accountability;
- professional integrity.

Conclusion

The EmpowerX Expert Committee represents a key governance component of the EmpowerX ecosystem.

By combining professional expertise, transparent procedures and independent evaluation, the Committee contributes to the credibility, sustainability and long-term development of the decentralized incubation model while reinforcing trust among founders, community participants and institutional stakeholders.